

In 1984, AT&T started selling UNIX as a proprietary product, and entered into a courtroom battle with BSD. It took AT&T five years to win that legal battle. During this time, businesses went with AT&T's clean room implementation to avoid any problems — people were looking for a System V style OS rather than a BSD style OS; so the popularity of BSD UNIX went down.

The Linux operating system was introduced in 1991. It was primarily developed for personal computers whereas UNIX was designed for server computers. So, researchers, students and businesses got attracted to Linux, mainly because Linux installation was economical and did not require much specific and high-end hardware.

Enterprises were much slower to take on Linux, but soon commercial support was available with Red Hat and others. Commercial software vendors started porting their applications to Linux. It was only a matter of time before Linux took over from proprietary

UNIX derivatives. Linux was UNIX at a much lower cost.

How UNIX is related to Linux and other open source software systems

In 1983, the GNU project was started by Richard Stallman with the goal of creating a completely free UNIX-like operating system. By early 1990, programs required for operating systems like compilers, text editors, UNIX shell, etc, were completed, but low-level elements such as device drivers were still under development.

The Richard Stallman-inspired, free, UNIX-like operating system was not ready with a kernel.

In 1991, that wait was over. Linus Torvalds, a student from the University of Helsinki, introduced the Linux kernel, which was developed as part of an educational project. Later, it merged with Stallman's GNU project that was UNIX-like but free.

The Linux operating system shares most of its components with UNIX. Text editors like Emacs, Vi, the UNIX shell, compilers and many more utilities are common in both Linux and UNIX. **END** 

References

- [1] <https://en.wikipedia.org>
- [2] http://www.unix.org/what_is_unix/history_timeline.html
- [3] <http://ibgwww.colorado.edu/~lessem/psyc5112/usail/concepts/hx-of-unix/unixhx.html>

 By: Swapnil Vivek Kulkarni

The author is a software engineer at Siemens PLM Software, Pune. He is inspired by open source software systems, loves to explore new technologies and enjoys programming. In his spare time, he likes to write articles on FOSS. He tweets as @swapnilkul.

FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK

We Value Your Feedback

We love to hear from you as **OSFY** consistently strives to make its content **informative, interesting and engaging.**

Please share your feedback/ thoughts/ views via email at osfyedit@efyindia.com.

We welcome your comments/ suggestions and encourage you to send them to:
The Editor, D-87/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 1, New Delhi-110020.

OpenSource
THE COMPLETE MAGAZINE ON OPEN SOURCE
ForYou

FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK FEEDBACK